The 1965 India-Pakistan war tested India's relations with Afghanistan. In the light of freshly acquired US weaponry, perceived support among the people of Kashmir, and an expected command crisis in New Delhi after Nehru's death, Pakistan launched a covert campaign, *Operation Gibraltar* in August 1965, followed by *Operation Grand Slam*.[26] The aim was to insurrect an anti-India rebellion in Kashmir and then send the Pakistan army to support it. Detecting the incursion belatedly, India responded by opening a separate war front in Punjab and nearly captured Lahore in September. The war did not result in outright military victory for either side. However, Pakistan's aggression unshackled India, temporarily, of its requirement to exercise restraint. Challenged at the UN by Pakistan's foreign minister Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto for ill-treating its Muslim minority and not allowing the people of Kashmir and Nagaland to exercise their right of self-determination, India unleashed a systematic counter-offensive on Pashtunistan, Balochistan, East Pakistan, and Pakistan-administered Kashmir. 'If Pakistan wants self-determination in Kashmir or Nagaland, constituent states of India, why does it not agree to grant self-determination to East Pakistan, Baluchistan, or the disputed territory of Pakhtoonistan?', countered Indian officials.[27] It was a point of principle. If the policy of self-determination were to be applied to parts of constitutionally created states, argued New Delhi, then most of them would break up. Pakistan's plea for self-determination in plural societies, as was the case with most states of Asia and Africa, was dismissed as political adventurism that would lead to the disintegration of postcolonial states. On 20 September 1965, weeks after the Indian forces had crossed the international border and closed in on Lahore, the UN passed a resolution seeking immediate ceasefire. Indian officials had calculated that Bhutto 'will bark and bark there [at the UN] and ultimately agree to the ceasefire'.[28] Indeed, Bhutto agreed to the ceasefire, but not without giving India a dressing-down on its 'colonial' attitude in Kashmir.

India's emphasis on territorial integrity over self-determination, alongside highlighting Pakistan's domestic problems had historical precedent. Lying to the south-west of Pakistan, despite its predominantly Muslim population, Balochistan did not automatically become part of Pakistan. When offered a referendum by the British to choose between India and Pakistan, the most